now a mainstream wellness solution for Gen Z, millennials and even seniors, so much so that just like dairy, fruits and vegetables, staples and beverages, high-protein food, too, is an FMCG category today, and the fastest-growing one.

The numbers are certainly impressive. According to market research firm IMARC Group, India's protein-based product market touched Rs 38,247 crore in 2024 and is projected to touch Rs 1.36 lakh crore by 2033, growing at a CAGR (compound annual growth rate) of 15.17 per cent. However, behind this phenomenal growth of protein foods lie hard nutritional facts—on the nature of protein and its intake by Indians.

Proteins are nutrients made up of strings of essential amino acids vital to the human body, and are the building blocks of cells and tissues, including muscle, bone, skin and hair. They are vital to the functioning of the body and are found in meat, fish, poultry, dairy products, nuts, beans, pulses and, in smaller quantities, in cereals. According to the Indian Council of Medical Research-National Institute of Nutrition (ICMR-NIN), the Recommended Dietary Allowance (RDA) is 0.83 gram of protein per kilogram of bodyweight a day for healthy individuals. Thus, an adult weighing 60 kg needs around 50 gm of protein daily.

India's average daily protein intake has been increasing over the years. The Household Consumption Expenditure Survey 2023-24 shows that intake rose from 59.3 grams per person per day in FY10 to 61.8 grams in FY24 in rural areas and from 58.8 grams per person per day in FY10 to 63.4 grams per day in FY24 in urban India. On the other hand, research published in Feb-



"The idea is to incorporate protein into the daily diet in an affordable and tasty manner, in formats that cater to consumers across age groups. We even offer a high-protein kulfi"

JAYEN MEHTA, *Managing Director, Amul*

₹38,247
CRORE
Size of India's protein-based product market In 2024

₹136,000
CRORE
Expected market size by 2033, at a CAGR of 15.17 per cent

(Source: IMARC Group)



Yoga Bar (backed by ITC)

High-protein oats, protein muesli, Power Up protein bars

50

High-protein products, also includes ProClean plant protein, protein shake cold coffee, ProClean whey protein

Amul

High-protein buttermilk, lassi, shakes, curd, whey protein beverages

10

A dozen more coming up, including snacking cubes, paneer parathas, protein water, high-protein atta, cola bars

15

Also includes protein chips in four flavours